

LANDMARKS

1996 rediff.com

Rediff.com was one of the first Indian B2C portals to offer localised content spanning several channels such as news, travel, money, etc., catering to the needs of users in India as well as the US. Rediff today is more than just a dotcom. It's an Internet, communications, and media company serving Indians worldwide.

1997 naukri.com

Formed on the foundation of a business in databases and reports, Naukri ran for the first three years without venture capital. After they made profits for two years in a row, they took funding for growth.

1998 contests.win.com

For years, contests in India were conducted using 'competition' postcards which had to be sourced from a post office and sent to post box numbers. C2W's idea was to serve contests to the consumer through the Web, so that they are available anytime, anywhere to anyone in a single click!

1999 FAB MART

Fabmart started off as a music store, but steadily increased its offerings to include books, computers, groceries, jewellery, music, movies, toys, and watches. It wasn't long before Fabmart, with its strong internal processes for logistics and a robust back-end supply chain system, built a base of over 1,60,000 shoppers worldwide.

2000 baazee.com

Baazee set the e-commerce fraternity on fire with an online auction model that concentrated on creating a trusting environment, where the best buyers could buy from the best sellers.

The 'next generation' dotcoms like Baazee, Travellini, Apnaloan, and Mouthshut had one thing in their favour: they'd seen plenty of dotcoms fall by the wayside and knew what not to do.



Alok Kejriwal
c2w.com

Every employee at C2W eats, sleeps, walks and talks about the brand! Business development team members know brand baselines, positioning, and the core promise by heart! We play 'Brand Antakshari' at work

Swarup attributes *Indiatimes'* success to a good business idea that translated well to the unique characteristics of the Internet. "Strategic pruning and re-mapping our goals based on the changing dynamics of the digital revolution has also played a key role in our success," says he. *Indiatimes'* innovations include the 8888 SMS service, which enables mobile phone users across India to access all information and interactive services on the site.

4. Online growth strategies

The secret of continuing success is to never allow yourself to rest on your laurels. It's imperative to always have a clear growth strategy in place.

Baazee recently acquired rival auction site *Bidorbuy.com*. "This has resulted in a lot of synergy between the two brands. Our combined buyer and seller base will have multiplicative effects in terms of sales on the site," says Bajaj. "It has also resulted in greater synergy in terms of revenue. We don't need to spend on marketing against each other. In addition, we also acquired their technology base".

"The real reason for *Naukri's* growth is that we have mastered the 'virtuous circle'. We've got the most jobs, so we get the most traffic, so we get the most response, so we get the most clients, again the most jobs and so on," says Bikhchandani. "Crucial to mastering this virtuous circle

all price points and to aggregate the most 'need to know' content, creating a powerful magnet that draws traffic without having to spend money on advertising". In order to grow and add a bricks-and-mortar element to their business, *Naukri* acquired Executive Search firm Quadrangle.

5. People are the key

People are your most valuable assets and are crucial to building a strong organisation. "Our people are extremely passionate," says Bajaj. "*Baazee* is firmly anchored around values and it's the people at *Baazee* that drive execution of ideas. We're a bottom-up organisation".

Bhikchandani concurs that a key learning has been that if we get the right people in the right jobs and motivate and empower them then the business will take care of itself. "This sounds simple and obvious but it isn't," he adds.

Bajaj agrees: "Execution comes from people. They need to feel elated about what they're doing. One should never lose touch with people working in the organisation".

The future

From many fingers in a small pie, the pie's now getting larger with a few players who understand how the cookie crumbles. Innovative ideas, a head for business and relentless focus on customers are some of

the things that saw these Dotcoms through. With Nasscom estimating the Internet subscriber figures in India (by December 2003) to be a whopping 50 million, it only gets better. If you add to this Indian Internet users who are more comfortable with transacting online and have

increased trust in Internet companies, the future certainly looks promising.

AVINA LOBO



Harsh Roongta
CEO, APNALOAN.COM

One must always adapt to one's business needs and continuously innovate and do new things

is our pricing strategy ranging from the cheapest (Rs 475) to the most expensive at Rs 6 lakh. This enables us to be present at